



NATIONAL RECONNAISSANCE OFFICE

14675 Lee Road
Chantilly, VA 20151-1715

8 April 2022

John Greenewald
27305 W. Live Oak Rd. Ste. 1203
Castaic, CA 91384

REF: NRO FOIA Case F-2021-00164
Request ID: 239586 Confirmation ID: 239061

Dear Mr. Greenewald:

This is in response to your request dated and received in the National Reconnaissance Office (NRO) on 22 July 2021. Pursuant to the Freedom of Information Act (FOIA), you are requesting, "A copy of all emails, sent to/from bcc/cc'd Director of the National Reconnaissance Office, Christopher J. Scolese, that contains the phrases and keywords: "Unidentified Aerial Phenomena" and/or "Aerial Phenomenon" and/or UAP and/or UFO and/or "Unidentified Flying Objects" and/or UAPs and/or UFOs and/or "UAP Task Force". I agree to limit the scope of my request to records dated August 5, 2019, through to the date of processing this request. I ask that you please include ALL ATTACHMENTS to the emails discovered, and that you search NIPRNET, SIPRNET and JWICS if that applies in this instance. Also, I agree to omit e-mails only of publicly available newspaper articles. but if there is commentary of any kind (information in addition to the article)."

We have processed your request in accordance with the FOIA, 5 U.S.C. § 552, as amended. After a thorough search of our files and databases, we located two documents responsive to your request. These documents are being released to you in part.

Material redacted is denied pursuant to FOIA exemptions:

(b) (1) as properly classified information under Executive Order 13526, Sections 1.4(c) and 1.4(g);

(b) (3), which is the basis for withholding information exempt from disclosure by statute. The relevant withholding statute is 10 U.S.C. § 424, which provides (except as required by the President or for information provided to Congress), that no provision of law shall be construed to require the disclosure of the organization or any function of the NRO; the number of persons employed by or assigned or detailed to the NRO; or the name or official title, occupational series, grade, or salary of any such person;

(b) (5), which applies to information that is predecisional and deliberative in nature; and

(b)(6), which applies to records which, if released, would constitute a clearly unwarranted invasion of the personal privacy of individuals.

You have the right to appeal this determination to the NRO Appellate Authority, 14675 Lee Road, Chantilly, VA 20151-1715, within 90 days of the above date. You may also submit an appeal electronically by completing the form available on the NRO's public web site at <http://www.nro.gov/foia/AppealInput.aspx>. Please include an explanation of the reason(s) for your appeal as part of your submission. The FOIA also provides that you may seek dispute resolution for any adverse determination through the NRO FOIA Public Liaison and/or through the Office of Government Information Services (OGIS). Please refer to the OGIS public web page at <https://ogis.archive.gov/> for additional information.

If you have any questions, please call the Requester Service Center at (703) 745-0600 and reference case number **F-2021-00164**.

Sincerely,



Anita Casamento
FOIA Public Liaison

Attachments:

- 1) C05136812
- 2) C05136818

This document is made available through the declassification efforts
and research of John Greenewald, Jr., creator of:

The Black Vault



The Black Vault is the largest online Freedom of Information Act (FOIA)
document clearinghouse in the world. The research efforts here are
responsible for the declassification of hundreds of thousands of pages
released by the U.S. Government & Military.

Discover the Truth at: **<http://www.theblackvault.com>**

(b)(3)

From: Bowman Thomas B NRO USA GOV
Sent: Wednesday, June 16, 2021 9:26 AM
To: Scolese Christopher J NRO USA GOV
Cc: Meink Troy E NRO USA GOV; Guetlein Michael MAJ GEN NRO-USSF USA MIL
Subject: FW: Status of actions regarding UAPs --- ~~TOP SECRET//SI//TK//RSEN/NOFORN/FISA~~
Attachments:

(b)(1)

--- ~~TOP SECRET//SI//TK//NOFORN/FISA~~

(b)(3)

UNCLASSIFIED//~~FOUO~~

Follow Up Flag: Follow up
Flag Status: Completed

Classification: ~~TOP SECRET//SI//TK//RSEN/NOFORN/FISA~~

(b)(3)

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Chris,

I am re-sending so you have this towards the top of your queue for awareness.

Blake

From: Bowman Thomas B NRO USA GOV
Sent: Wednesday, June 9, 2021 4:26 PM
To: Scolese Christopher J NRO USA GOV [REDACTED] Meink Troy E NRO USA GOV [REDACTED]
Guetlein Michael MAJ GEN NRO-USSF USA MIL [REDACTED]
Cc: [REDACTED]

(b)(3)

Subject: Status of actions regarding UAPs --- ~~TOP SECRET//SI//TK//RSEN/NOFORN/FISA~~

Classification: ~~TOP SECRET//SI//TK//RSEN/NOFORN/FISA~~

(b)(3)

Sirs,

~~(S//NF)~~ As I was listed as the NRO POC for efforts tied to the DoD's Unidentified Areal Phenomena (UAPs) Task Force, I am providing you with an update to NRO UAP-related activities. There are three efforts to bring to your attention:

1. The final version of the UAP Task Force Report to Congress is out for coordination and due 10 June (tomorrow); NRO's contribution is four paragraphs tied to collection efforts (details follow) (b)(1)
2. [redacted] (b)(3)
3. The DoD IG interviewed several MID officers on NRO's UAP efforts as part of their work to determine DoD's response to the UAP topic; NRO IG officers were present for the entire meeting (details follow)

The documents attached to this note provide details on each topic in case you wish to delve further into any of the three topics, [redacted] this note provides a summary of the substantive details. (b)(3)

Further details:

1) ~~(S//NF)~~ Comments from the NRO on the final version of the UAP TF Congressional Report [redacted] are due (b)(3) June 10. NRO/ES assigned D/MID as the final NRO coordination signature and I provided my coordination signature today. Here is NRO's input:

~~(TS//TK//NF)~~ The NRO performs R&D, acquires, launches, and operates sensors and communications systems on satellites on behalf of national security and thus our input and coordination is limited to our sensor performance, processing, and exploitation (tool) capabilities allowing intelligence community analysts to fully exploit, assess, and report their findings. An NRO officer on the UAP TF Advisory Panel provided feedback on NRO platforms, (b)(1) sensors, data processing and information exploitation, [redacted] (b)(3)

[redacted] Any collection tasking would need to come from NGA for GEOINT or NSA for SIGINT. Once actual or hypothetical observables or activity are codified, the NRO can work with our mission partners to not only optimize collection (b)(1) but possibly enhance processing and exploitation to capture and characterize these events. (b)(3)

2) ~~(S//RSEN//NF)~~(b)(1)
(b)(3)~~(S//NF)~~~~(S//NF)~~(b)(1)
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(b)(3)

3) ~~(S//NF)~~ The DoD/IG started a project [redacted] to assess the department's efforts to explain UAPs and characterize the threat to national security and risk to flight. [redacted] staff from the DoD/IG interviewed officers from MID with NRO/IG officers attending. MID was careful to remind the DoD/IG staff of our charter which limits us from tasking satellite collection or performing analysis. MID further shared the inputs we provided the UAP TF and a [redacted] MID sent a link to (b)(1) NGA product to the DoD IG staff. The DoD IG indicated a data call would be formally tasked to the NRO in about two (b)(3) weeks.

Please let me know if you have any questions or concerns.

Thank you,
Blake

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NON-RESPONSIVE RECORD

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[REDACTED]

From: Scolese Christopher J
Sent: Thursday, October 15, 2020 10:54 AM
To: [REDACTED]
Subject: UFO?

(b)(3)

[REDACTED]

[REDACTED]

(b)(5)
(b)(6)

Scientists Call For Serious Study Of 'Unidentified Aerial Phenomena'
(LiveScience)

Chris